of 1975, matters appeared to have been resolved, but some of the Nagas saw this as a betrayal of their core demands and formed the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (NSCN) in 1980, continuing the armed insurrection against India. The NSCN had undergone many splits over the years over ideological and personal reasons and there were now as many as eight different groups operating in Nagaland, the main ones being the NSCN (IM), NSCN (KK) and NSCN (K). However, a ceasefire was in place with all the insurgent groups since 1997, so there was relative peace and quiet in Nagaland. That had not always been the case and the 1980s had seen some of the deadliest ambushes and casualties suffered by the Army.

IGAR (N) with its HQ at Kohima, had three Sectors (Brigade equivalent) under it: HQ 7 Sector was at Tuensang, HQ 5 Sector at Chieswema and HQ 7 Sector at Dimapur only a little distance away from HQ 3 Corps, which was at the Rangapahar Military Station. Between them, they had eleven AR Battalions looking after the (then) eleven districts of Nagaland. The tasks of the Battalions were fairly simple in that they were to enforce the ceasefire ground rules, keep the rival factions at bay and ensure that there was no forcible recruitment or extortion in the name of 'taxation'. The Battalions deployed in the border districts of Mon, Tuensang, Kiphire and Phek additionally had a border guarding and management role along the Indo-Myanmar border, akin to what the BSF does along the Indo-Pak or Indo-Bangladesh border. Since then, a number of new districts have been created, and now, Nagaland has a total of sixteen districts, largely configured on tribal lines.

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